

MANIPUR TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY

GUIDELINES FOR CONSIDERATION OF PUBLICATIONS FOR ACADEMIC AND RESEARCH EVALUATION

In reference to the University Grants Commission (UGC) Notification F. No. 1-1/2018(CARE/JOURNAL) dated 16 July 2025, and the Public Notice issued on 11 February 2025, Manipur Technical University (MTU) hereby adopts the UGC's suggestive parameters for identifying peer-reviewed journals (Annexure-I).

A journal shall be considered peer-reviewed for the purposes of Manipur Technical University only if it meets the quality and transparency parameters outlined under the section "Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework" (refer Appendix A).

Publications appear in journals indexed in the SCOPUS or Web of Science (Science Citation Index Expanded, Arts and Humanities Citation Index, or Social Sciences Citation Index) or peer-reviewed journals that meet the parameters in the "Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework" (refer Appendix A) shall be considered.

The criteria shall be applicable to, but not limited to, faculty recruitment, faculty performance evaluations, Career Advancement Scheme (CAS) promotions, eligibility and recognition of Ph.D. supervisors, research grant applications and internal incentive schemes, thesis evaluation and academic assessments, institutional ranking submissions, accreditations, reporting requirements, and other related academic or research activities requiring journal validation.

To ensure effective implementation of this policy, the responsibility for screening and verifying journals shall rest with the Board of Studies of the respective departments, and Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC).

All academic departments and evaluation committees must ensure that research publications submitted for any academic or research-related purpose are published in peer-reviewed journals or in SCOPUS/WOS indexed journals.

All faculty members, research scholars, and academic functionaries are directed to adhere strictly to this policy.

1. JOURNAL EVALUATION CRITERIA

To standardize the assessment of peer-reviewed journals, the following criteria are used:

1.1 Journal Preliminary Criteria

Purpose: To confirm the authenticity, transparency, and academic credibility of journals.

1.1.1 Title and ISSN:

A unique and verifiable journal identity strengthens trust and traceability.

Journals should have a unique, verifiable ISSN (for print or online) that matches the title listed in ISSN databases (ISSN Portal, NSL ISSN Process).

1.1.2 Minimum Publication History:

Publication history reflects editorial maturity.

Journals must demonstrate at least 3 years of consistent publication.

1.1.3 Publication Frequency:

Regular publication ensures predictability and accountability.

Journals must specify and adhere to a consistent schedule as stated in the ISSN records.

1.1.4 Contact and Publication Details:

Clear publisher information strengthens legitimacy.

The journal must provide clear details about the publisher, including the address, society affiliations (if any), and verifiable contact information.

1.1.5 Transparent Review Policy:

A transparent review process maintains scholarly standards.

The journal must clearly state the type of peer review (e.g., single or double-blind), and all published articles must go through peer review.

1.1.6 Website:

A secure and professional website reflects academic credibility.

The journal's website must be secure, up-to-date, and linked to the publisher's platform.

1.1.7 Open Access or Subscription-Based Policy:

Clear access models benefit both authors and readers.

Journals must specify whether they follow an open access or subscription-based model and list any applicable fees.

1.1.8 Integration with National/International Repositories:

Linkages with repositories improve discoverability and citation.

It is desirable that Journals are connected to platforms like CrossRef, ORCID, ONOS, OpenDOAR, CORE, PMC, or Zenodo.

1.1.9 Digital Identifiers (DOIs):

DOIs ensure persistent linking and proper citation.

All articles must be assigned valid, verifiable DOIs.

1.1.10 Reputed publisher

Ensures quality scientific journal

A journal published by a reputed publisher is generally regarded as a quality scientific journal. However, its mere inclusion in a publisher's catalogue alone does not guarantee its quality. Therefore, the journal must also meet the evaluation criteria outlined in these guidelines.

1.2 Editorial Board Evaluation

Purpose: To assess the editorial integrity, academic leadership, and transparency of the journal's governing structure.

1.2.1 Editorial Board Composition:

Editorial boards reflect academic stewardship.

Full names, roles, affiliations, and identifiers (ORCID/Researcher ID) of all editorial members must be listed. Editorial members should have recognized academic standing aligned with the journal's scope.

1.2.2 Diversity and Expertise:

Academic diversity enhances global relevance.

Board members must represent multiple institutions and geographies and align with the journal's scope.

1.2.3 Editorial Independence:

Independence prevents undue influence and bias.

Efficient, impartial peer review workflows with documented timelines and responsiveness to reviewer feedback

1.3 Editorial and Ethical Policies

Purpose: To ensure alignment between editorial policies, declared aims, and ethical best practices.

1.3.1 Aims and Scope:

Clarity of focus ensures scholarly relevance.

Journals must clearly define focus areas and goals of the journal.

1.3.2 Article Processing Charges (APC):

Hidden fees undermine trust.

Article Processing Charges must be clearly stated.

1.3.3 Publishing Timeline:

Timeliness improves author satisfaction.

Journals should state and follow realistic submission-to-publication timelines.

1.3.4 Acceptance Rate:

Selectivity indicates the rigor of the review process.

Acceptance statistics should be provided and should represent genuine screening.

1.3.5 Ethical Alignment:

Global standards ensure responsible publication.

Adherence to COPE or equivalent standards must be reflected in journal policies.

1.4 Content Quality Standards

Purpose: To evaluate academic originality, policy relevance, and conformity to journal scope.

1.4.1 Research Contribution:

Publications must demonstrate innovation and scholarly merit.

Articles should reflect theoretical advancement, evidence-based analysis, and real-world applicability.

1.4.2 Conformity to Journal Scope:

Consistency across title, theme, and output is essential.

Published articles must align with the journal's stated aims and objectives.

The journal should maintain a consistent theme.

1.5 Presentation and Technical Standards

Purpose: To uphold credibility and ensure optimal dissemination of scholarly work through design, accessibility, and consistent publishing practices.

1.5.1 Bibliographic Data and Literature Citation:

Accurate, consistent citation practices support academic attribution and traceability.

Journals should use a standardized referencing style (e.g., APA, MLA, Vancouver) and include a "Cite as" recommendation in each article to encourage uniform citation.

1.5.2 Design and Readability:

A well-formatted journal improves readability and reflects editorial quality.

Journals should use clear fonts, consistent formatting, and proper spacing. High quality visuals like tables, graphs, and infographics must be well-labelled and enhance the article's content.

1.5.3 Archiving and Accessibility:

Long-term preservation and ease of access are essential for sustained research visibility.

Journals should provide full-text content online. Subscription-based journals must list article metadata, while open-access journals must ensure complete availability.

Archival mechanisms (e.g., LOCKSS, Portico) should be clearly documented.

1.5.4 Multilingual Availability:

Language diversity promotes inclusivity and enhances local research impact, particularly in the Indian context.

Journals are encouraged to publish in Indian languages in addition to English to broaden accessibility.

1.5.5 Submission Platform:

Secure and structured submission systems foster transparency and process integrity.

Manuscripts must be submitted through an online submission portal. Journals accepting submissions via email should be excluded from consideration.

1.5.6 Avoidance of Rapid Publication Claims:

Unrealistic promises of quick publication often signal compromised peer-review processes.

Journals that highlight "rapid review" or "instant publication" as marketing claims should be avoided unless backed by transparent editorial policies.

1.5.7 Print Continuum:

Consistency in print reflects editorial discipline and strengthens the journal's professional identity.

Journals with print editions should ensure uniformity in layout, design, and formatting across all issues.

1.5.8 PDF Accessibility and Permissions:

Unrestricted access to published content facilitates academic sharing and citation.

Journals must not use copy-protected or locked PDFs. Downloadable, citation friendly formats must be provided.

1.6 Research Ethics and Compliance

Purpose: To ensure journals follow established ethical standards, uphold academic integrity, and encourage responsible research practices.

1.6.1 Ethical Guidelines for Authors:

Authors must follow clear publication ethics set by the journal.

Journals should publish and enforce detailed ethical policies and have formal structures to monitor ethical compliance.

1.6.2 Plagiarism Prevention:

Maintaining originality and academic integrity is crucial.

Journals must strictly follow UGC Level 0 plagiarism norms (with similarity under 10%).

1.6.3 Conflict of Interest Disclosure:

Transparent disclosure practices maintain integrity for all stakeholders.

Any potential conflicts of interest involving authors, editors, or reviewers must be disclosed.

1.6.4 AI Content Disclosure:

Responsible use of AI in research must be clearly disclosed.

Journals should require authors to disclose any AI-generated or AI-assisted content.

1.6.5 Research Integrity Policy:

Journals must align with globally accepted codes of research conduct.

Endorsement of standards like COPE, WAME, or the Declaration of Helsinki must be visible.

1.6.6 Intellectual Property:

Respecting ownership and licensing enhance academic trust.

Policies on copyright, licensing, and author rights must be clearly outlined.

1.6.7 Post-Publication Corrections:

Timely corrections ensure reliability of the scholarly record.

Retraction and correction procedures must be publicly available.

1.6.8 Data Sharing and Reproducibility:

Encouraging open science practices benefits the wider research community.

Journals should support data availability, replication, and reuse.

1.6.9 Complaints and Appeals:

Fair and documented grievance mechanisms promote accountability.

A transparent process must exist for handling complaints and appeals. Allegations of misconduct must be addressed using COPE or equivalent guidelines.

1.7 Journal Visibility

Purpose: To ensure recognition, academic influence, and engagement with the scholarly community.

1.7.1 Impact Metrics:

Impact metrics serve as indicators of scholarly reach.

Valid Impact Factor (Clarivate), CiteScore (Scopus), or SJR. Journals using misleading or unverified metrics (SJIF, Cosmos, GIF, etc.) will be disqualified.

1.7.2 Indexation in Reputed Databases:

Indexing enhances discoverability and academic credibility.

Journals should be listed in databases such as Scopus, Web of Science, Education Resources Information Center (ERIC), Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ), PsycINFO, HeinOnline, or LexisNexis.

1.8 Journal Impact Criteria

Purpose: To assess a journal's influence, citation frequency, and academic relevance compared to peers.

1.8.1 Citation Rate:

Citations reflect the utility and relevance of published work.

Journals should demonstrate citation frequency commensurate with their scope.

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To have a quantifiable evaluation of Peer-reviewed Journals based on the detailed parameters discussed above, the following Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework shall be used.

2. Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework

To ensure objective assessment, the accompanying 150-point framework across six categories must be used:

Sl.no.	Evaluation Domain	Maximum points
1	Journal Identification and Authenticity	30
2	Editorial Board and Governance	30
3	Peer Review and Publishing Process	30
4	Website and Infrastructure	20
5	Metrics and Indexing	20
6	Ethics and Compliance	20

Scoring Guidelines

- **Total Points: 150**
- **Minimum Acceptance Threshold: 120/150**

Journals meeting a minimum of 120 points out of 150 are acceptable only.

- **Automatic Rejection Triggers:**

Journals exhibiting any of the following fundamental flaws shall be automatically excluded from consideration:

- ❖ Invalid or fake ISSN;
- ❖ Anonymous or unverifiable publisher;
- ❖ Absence of a clearly stated peer review policy;
- ❖ Absence of an appropriate Manuscript submission mechanism;
- ❖ Use of non-standard or predatory metrics (e.g., Scientific Journal Impact Factor (SJIF), Cosmos Impact Factor, CiteFactor, General/Global Impact Factor (GIF), AE Global Index);

- ❖ Absence of a publicly available research ethics and publication policy;
- ❖ Use of cloned or deceptively similar journal titles mimicking reputed journals;
- ❖ Inclusion in recognized blacklists (e.g., Beall's List, Cabell's Predatory Reports, DOAJ's list of journals claiming to be indexed in DOAJ or the UGC CARE Excluded List);
- ❖ Not included in the various databases mentioned on the journal website;
- ❖ Engagement in unethical research or publishing practices

For detailed scoring rubrics and indicators under each evaluation domain, refer to the attached “Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework” (Appendix A).

Appendix A

Comprehensive Journal Evaluation Framework					
Sub-Criterion	Evaluation Method	Max Points	Quantitative Indicator	Red Flags	Verifiable Sources
1. Journal Identification and Authenticity (30 pts)					
ISSN Verification	Must match across all sources	5	ISSN match Yes = 5 No = 0	Not found on ISSN portal	https://portal.issn.org , https://nsl.niscpr.res.in/
Distinct Title	Matched via similarity checks	5	Unique = 5 Cloned = 0	Mimics known titles	Scopus, WoS, ERIC, PsycINFO, IEEE Xplore, DOAJ
Publisher Legitimacy	Verify with Goods and Services Tax (GST), Registrar of Companies (ROC)	5	Registered = 5 Anonymous = 0	No legal identity	GST, ROC
Journal History	Verified 3+ years of issues	4	>3 yrs = 4 2–3 yrs = 3 1–2 yrs = 2 <1 yr = 1	New/discontinued	Archive.org, journal archive
Publisher Transparency	Must list the owner, address, and contact details	4	Full = 4 None = 0	Shell/anonymous	Publisher's site, CrossRef google.be/maps/
DOI Verification (if applicable)	Must resolve through DOI.org	4	Valid DOI = 4 Fake = 0 If not applicable = 4	Broken links	CrossRef, DOI.org
Reputed publisher	Must be published by professional publishers, Learned or scholarly societies, University Presses	3	Yes = 3 No = 0	Not published by Reputed publisher	
2. Editorial Board and Governance (30 pts)					
Verified Affiliations	50% sample cross check	4	≥90% = 4 Otherwise = 0	Fake/ Fabricated board	ORCID, Institution sites
Geographic & Institutional Diversity	≥3 countries (for International) 5+ institutions (for National)	4	3+/5+ = 4 In-house = 0	Monolithic board	Editorial Page
Editor-in-Chief Visibility	h-index check	6	h-index ≥15 = 6 10–14 = 4 5–9 = 2 ≤5 = 0	Inactive/unknown	Google Scholar, Scopus
ORCID/ID Availability	≥50% members	3	≥50% = 3 Otherwise = 0	None	ORCID, Publons
Special Issue Editors	Named with affiliation	3	Yes = 3 No = 0	Guest editors hidden	Journal Issues
Editorial Activity	3–5 years of publication/research involvement	4	Verified = 4 None = 0	Dormant	Grants.gov, websites
Independence	Policy on editorial	3	Yes = 3	Publisher control	Journal policy page

Declaration	freedom		No = 0		
Author-Editor Overlap	<10% per issue	3	<10% = 3 10–20% = 1 >20% = 0	>20%	Article review data
3. Peer Review & Publishing Process (30 pts)					
Type of Review	Specified clearly	6	Double blind/Single-blind = 6 Unclear = 0	No peer review	Review Policy Page
Reviewer Pool Acknowledged	Publicly listed	2	Public pool = 2 Sample = 1 None = 0	No reviewers shown	Journal page
Review Timeline	Submission to the decision	6	More than four weeks = 6 1 to 4 weeks = 3 <1 week = 0	Unrealistic durations	Article metadata.
Peer Review History	Timeline published	4	≥80% of articles = 4 50–79% = 2 <50% = 0	No data	Metadata fields
Acceptance Dates Consistency	Submission precedes acceptance	4	Yes = 4 No = 0	Backdated acceptances	Article dates
Appeals Process	Clear process posted	4	Yes = 4 No = 0	No grievance route	Submission guidelines
Retraction/Correction Policy for publication	Public COPE aligned policy	4	Yes = 4 No = 0	No retraction protocol	Journal policy
4. Website & Infrastructure (20 pts)					
Language Quality	Checked for grammar/plagiarism	3	Clean = 3 Major = 0	Major issues	Grammarly, Copyscape
Metadata Standards	Schema.org, OAI PMH used	3	Full = 3 None = 0	None	OAI-PMH validators
Citation Format	Standardized style	3	APA/MLA = 3 Unclear = 0	Inconsistent	Author guidelines
Archive Access	≥5 years of content	2	≥5 yrs = 2 2–4 yrs = 1 <2 yrs = 0	No archive	Journal site
Author-oriented rather than reader oriented	Journal site	3	Yes = 0 No = 3	Submission possibilities are highlighted. Information regarding publishing possibilities, such as quick peer review, are foregrounded	Journal site
Search Functionality	Article search works	2	Yes = 2 No = 0	Broken search	Homepage
Article Licensing	License clearly stated	2	Yes = 2	None	Article/PDF

			No = 0		
Custom CMS	Unique platform, not generic	2	Customized = 2 Default = 0	Basic template	Page source code
5. Metrics & Indexing (20 pts)					
Indexing in Major Databases	Verified in Scopus, WoS, DOAJ/ERIC/ PsycINFO/HeinOnline/ LexisNexis	6	Yes = 6 No = 0	Not indexed	Index sites https://doaj.org/ https://www.apa.org/pubs/databases/psycinfo https://eric.ed.gov/ https://www.apa.org/pubs/databases/psycinfo https://home.heinonline.org/
Misleading Metrics Used	e.g., SJIF, GIF, Cosmos	6	None used = 6 Used = 0	Fake metric	Homepage
Google Scholar Citations	20 latest articles	6	>100 = 6 50–100 = 3 <50 = 1	Low impact	Google Scholar
h5-index	Verified via Google Scholar	2	h5 > 10 = 2	Low ranking	Google Scholar
6. Ethics and Compliance (20 pts)					
Research Ethics Policy	Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE)/ International Committee of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE)/ World Association of Medical Editors (WAME)	6	Yes = 6 No = 0	None	COPE (https://publicationethics.org/membership), ICMJE (https://www.icmje.org/) WAME (https://www.wame.org/) Journal website
AI Disclosure	Mandatory in the author guidelines	3	Yes = 3 No = 0	Unclear policy	Policy page
Plagiarism Check	iThenticate/Turnitin	6	Regular check = 6 None = 0	No screening	Similarity report
Community Standards	COPE Core Practices linked	3	Yes = 3 No = 0	Not compliant	COPE.org
Conflict of Interest Policy	Journal site	2	Yes = 2 No = 0	Unclear or no policy	Homepage